Declutter Checklist

Kitchen, bathroom, bedroom and living room. Work in short sessions.

Kitchen and pantry

- [ ] Expired or stale pantry food (check before you toss) — Trash
- [ ] Freezer food with freezer burn or no label — Trash
- [ ] Duplicate utensils and gadgets you have not used in a year — Donate
- [ ] Extra mugs and water bottles that do not fit one shelf — Donate
- [ ] Food containers with no matching lid — Recycle
- [ ] Old sponges and worn dish towels — Trash
- [ ] Takeout menus, sauce packets, rubber bands — Trash

Living room and electronics

- [ ] Old phones and tablets (back up, remove SIM, reset) — Recycle
- [ ] Chargers and cables for devices you no longer own — Recycle
- [ ] Used batteries (tape lithium-ion terminals) — Hazardous
- [ ] Books, DVDs and games you will not use again — Donate
- [ ] Old magazines and catalogs — Recycle
- [ ] Extra throw pillows and blankets — Donate

Bathroom and medicine cabinet

- [ ] Expired or unused medicines — Take-back
- [ ] Mascara older than 3 months — Trash
- [ ] Eye makeup you used during an eye infection — Trash
- [ ] Sunscreen past its date, or over 3 years old — Trash
- [ ] Samples and hotel toiletries you will not use — Donate
- [ ] Old towels and bath mats — Donate
- [ ] Empty bottles and tubes — Recycle

Bedroom and closet

- [ ] Clothes that do not fit or you have not worn in a year — Donate
- [ ] Shoes and bags in good shape you no longer use — Donate
- [ ] Worn-out clothes, odd socks, stretched underwear — Recycle
- [ ] Bedding sets beyond two per bed — Donate
- [ ] Broken jewelry and tangled chains — Trash
- [ ] Wire hangers and extra plastic hangers — Recycle

Before you start

Set a timer: 5 to 15 minutes at a time beats one exhausting weekend.

Use four boxes: donate, recycle, trash and put-away, so nothing gets re-sorted.

One spot at a time: a shelf or a drawer, not the whole room.

Out the same day: put donations in the car before you stop.

Declutter Checklist

Paperwork, kids' rooms, garage and laundry, plus where everything goes.

Home office and paperwork

- [ ] Bank statements, bills and card offers you no longer need — Shred
- [ ] Tax records past the IRS keep period — Shred
- [ ] Manuals you can find online — Recycle
- [ ] Warranties for things you no longer own — Shred
- [ ] Dried-out pens and used notebooks — Trash
- [ ] Home purchase and improvement records — Keep

Kids' rooms and baby gear

- [ ] Outgrown clothes and shoes — Donate
- [ ] Toys and puzzles with missing pieces — Trash
- [ ] Drop-side cribs or cribs made before June 28, 2011 — Trash
- [ ] Car seats past their date or after a moderate crash — Trash
- [ ] Outgrown baby gear (check for recalls first) — Donate
- [ ] School papers and art: keep a few favorites — Keep

Garage, laundry and cleaning shelf

- [ ] Old paint, solvents, pesticides and motor oil — Hazardous
- [ ] Cleaners and drain openers you no longer use — Hazardous
- [ ] Broken tools and duplicates — Recycle
- [ ] Outgrown bikes and sports gear — Donate
- [ ] Smoke alarms 10 years old or older — Replace
- [ ] Dried-out or half-used laundry products — Trash

Where it goes

Donate	charity shop, shelter or a friend
Recycle	curbside or a drop-off point
Trash	regular garbage
Take-back	pharmacy kiosk or take-back site
Hazardous	hazardous waste or battery drop-off
Shred	shred, then recycle the paper
Keep	file it safely
Replace	swap for a new one

Notes: donation drop-offs, take-back sites, pickup days